

The Power of an Intercessor

We are going to continue our study of the laws of meditation, so I want you to open to Luke 13.

In passing in review briefly, we found out:

Blessed is the man that walketh not in the counsel of the ungodly, nor standeth in the way of sinners... But his delight is in the law of the Lord; and in His law doth he meditate day and night.

Once again, what qualifies me to be that blessed man of God? Number one, if I do not take my counsel from the world. Number two, if I do not do things the way sinners do.

If I am not going to take my counsel from the world, then I had better take this one step further, which is Psalm 1:2. This man delights himself in the Word of God, and in that Word he meditates day and night.

What is the purpose for meditation? The purpose for meditation is to extract the counsel from the Word of God that you and I walk by, so we do not have to do things the way sinners do, nor do we have to take our counsel from the world.

Then we went on to find out one thing that we all agree on. We have no trouble agreeing on this fact: Jesus is the Master Teacher. He is the greatest Teacher who ever lived. Amen?

Jesus said, "What I hear the Holy Spirit say, that I say, and what I see Him do, that I do."

Now there is one thing I found about Jesus Christ, my Teacher: when He was contending with the Pharisees, it was one thing, but when He was teaching, He always taught in total and entire subjects.

It has been us preachers, with our own pet doctrines of flesh, who have lifted verses out of context, one here, one here, one there, to strengthen our own personal doctrines, whether they are right or wrong.

Jesus always taught in total and entire subjects. He never went on to the next subject until He finished the one He was on.

If Jesus was teaching at this pulpit using the mastery of words, He would begin painting a picture in your spirit at the top of this pulpit. By the time He reached the bottom, He would have painted that perfect picture in your spirit.

That means every Scripture does not stand alone. Every verse is a thought within itself. It is a stroke of the brush. But invariably, it is always building toward the completion of the entire picture.

Think about this. If I took a corn seed, smashed it with a hammer into four fragments, and planted the fragments claiming I would receive a greater harvest, I would get nothing. The reason I would get nothing is because I destroyed the image that was on the inside of the seed.

He said faith is like a mustard seed. Faith carries an image in it. The way you get the image out is by planting the image in your spirit. If I fragment the Word, I get nothing.

Faith comes by hearing and hearing by what the Word of God said about your problem. Not the flesh, not the devil, not the world, not popular doctrines. Faith comes by hearing and hearing and hearing and hearing what the Word said about your problem.

Faith does not come from what fragments of the Word said about your problem. Faith comes by hearing and hearing by what the Word said.

"I do not believe tongues are for today."

You are wrong.

"I do not believe healing is for today."

You are wrong.

"I do not believe prosperity is for today."

You are wrong.

How did you get that? Those are doctrines of flesh, and they came because somebody fragmented the Word of God. The whole Word does not agree with you.

Jesus always taught in total and entire subjects. He never took a verse out of context. We should never take a verse out of context.

With this rule in mind, let us begin with Luke 13:1.

Are you ready?

Now stop just a moment. I need to say this. If I say stop, even if we are in the middle of a word, a sentence, or a comma, if I say stop, you stop and look at me. What we are about to say is totally based on what we are saying.

If you do not stop, I am going to look over at you and say, "If you do not read the Word of God while you are at home, why do you read it while I am talking to you? That is rude."

Let us begin.

I can feel miracles. I feel Him pacing me. When He is pacing me, He gives me so long to teach what I am going to teach, then He changes the anointing and goes out and starts working miracles. If I do not catch the change, He leaves me up here babbling. If you do not think I can babble, I have found the best thing to do is catch it when He changes and go with Him.

I know a lot of preachers who are left standing behind the pulpit babbling because God went off and did something else.

Luke 13:1:

There were present at that season some that told Him of the Galileans, whose blood Pilate had mingled with their sacrifices. And Jesus answering said unto them, Suppose ye that these Galileans were sinners above all the Galileans, because they suffered such things? I tell you, Nay: but, except ye repent, ye shall all likewise perish. Or those eighteen, upon whom the tower in Siloam fell, and slew them, think ye that they were sinners above all men that dwelt in Jerusalem? I tell you, Nay: but, except ye repent, ye shall all likewise perish.

Notice the second verse. It took me a while to get this out of here in my meditations. Every time I would pass over that verse, refusing to take it out of context, something would almost come to my spirit and then I would lose it.

Evidently, they asked Jesus a question. What I could not pick up was the question they had asked Him, because it is evident in the second verse that Jesus was answering the question. They demanded His attention.

He said:

Suppose ye that these Galileans were sinners above all the Galileans, because they suffered such things?

Then most emphatically He says, "No, they were not."

It finally dawned on me what question they asked Him. They were present with Him and told Him of the Galileans that Pilate had murdered, mingling their blood with their sacrifices. What these people present with Jesus wanted to know was, "How come these Galileans' number came up? Why these handful out of all the other Galileans dwelling in Galilee? Why them? Was it, Jesus, because they were bigger sinners than anybody else?"

Then of those eighteen upon whom the tower in Siloam fell and killed them, an accidental death, they asked Jesus, "Were these eighteen bigger sinners? We want to know why. Why did their number come up and this group's number did not?"

When it dawned on me through meditation that Jesus was answering one of the most difficult questions probably in the entire Word of God, you do not think I got my meditator out and meditated and meditated until it felt like it fell out on the ground?

I meditated because I do not know how many times somebody has sat down across from my desk and said, "Brother Roberson, can you tell me why my Uncle John was killed in the war? Can you tell me why my wife died? Can you tell me why I lost my son in Vietnam? Can you please tell me why my husband died?"

Their eyes were so full of hurt for years, and I did not know what to tell them.

But there is one thing you are going to find out about these laws of meditation: Jesus will never make a statement like this without going on in minute detail and giving you the answer. Most of us have never hung around His messages long enough to even finish one of them, much less get the answer. We are too busy jumping on little statements and little verses, conforming them to us so they give us a license to preach any old thing we want.

Where do you think faith comes from anyway?

Jesus said, "Do you think it was because they were bigger sinners? I tell you, no."

You see it all the time. It has been a mystery to me. There will be the local town hellion, and brother, he is a hellion. You have these guys running around. The local town hellion cruises Main Street, dopes, picks up your kids, and gets them hooked on dope. Here is this local town hellion. He has survived three airplane crashes, two car wrecks, and one train derailment.

Every time he crawls out of a compartment squashed up about this big, he comes crawling out on his hands and knees and says, "I will tell you one thing, I walked away from that one again, didn't I?"

You think he should have been killed. All he does is pick our daughters up and cruise Main and dope and everything else.

Then the mystery of it: there will be the town banker, the pillar of the community. There is no charitable fund ever offered where he was not on the front row donating large sums of money. Every time a building or shelter needed to be built for winos, drunks, and the poor, he headed the committee. Brother, this guy was the pillar of the community.

Yet one day he walks out the back of his bank, trips on the porch, and kills himself.

It just did not make any sense. So they asked Jesus, "Why? Why did this guy's plane go down and this one did not? Why? Was it because they were greater sinners than these?"

Jesus said, "I tell you, no."

All that sin is, is the fruit of spiritual death. Man does not go to hell because he is a sinner. He goes to hell because he is spiritually dead.

He said, "No, they are not perishing because they are greater sinners."

My question to Jesus was, "Then why are they perishing? Why this man over this man?"

Do you know what He told me? In those days when He was teaching me to meditate, it was almost His favorite saying in me. I would get a verse out of context and keep asking Him what it meant. He finally started answering me, because I was praying a lot.

He would say, "Roberson, when are you going to quit taking these verses out of context?"

My favorite answer in those days was, "How about now?"

Then He said to me, "If you would finish the message I was preaching in this thirteenth chapter, I could show you why one man perishes and one does not."

I said, "But Lord, I thought I already had finished it."

He said, "No, you have not."

Now do you mind tonight if I treat you like "Sally, see the ball"? For if Sally sees the ball, so will Jane, Susie, and little Tommy.

I said, "Lord, what do You mean? What do You mean if I quit changing the subject?"

Remember, we are studying laws of meditation.

He told me, "Look at the sixth verse."

Stay with me very closely now.

He spake also this parable.

He spake also, A-L-S-O, also this parable.

Stop. Sally, see the ball. Sally, do you know what the word also means? If I say, "I ran twenty-seven miles a day, for I have also, in conjunction to this, entered the marathon," would it do me any good to enter the marathon if my entering of the marathon was not one thousand percent based on the foundational fact that I first worked out in preparation?

The word also is the conjunction that tied the two events together.

He says, "He spake also," meaning in conjunction with what He has already said. He spake also this parable.

Now, what is a parable, Sally? A parable in its most basic meaning is something I can understand with my natural mind that illustrates a spiritual application.

What did Jesus use parables for? He would say, "The kingdom of God is as a mustard seed." I can tell you what a mustard seed is. I can understand it with my mind. But the operation of a mustard seed illustrates a spiritual principle.

He said, "The kingdom of God is as a pearl of great price. The kingdom of God is as a treasure hidden in a field. The kingdom of God is as fish gathered in the net. The kingdom of God is as little children. The kingdom of God is as a householder."

He gives you a whole list of things you can identify with your natural mind, but they are designed to make you understand a spiritual application.

What spiritual application is He trying to make us understand? They asked, "Jesus, was it because these Galileans were greater sinners than any other Galileans in Galilee?"

He says, "No. One does not perish over another man because he is a greater sinner."

Then He spake this parable. What is the parable designed to do? Cause you to understand the spiritual principle of why one man dies and one does not.

It makes you want to go ahead and read it, does it not? But you are afraid to. Your neck tilted a few times, but you pulled it back up, did you not? You are thinking, "I have got to read it now. I have got to find out why."

Folks, it was there all the time. As long as the Bible has been on your shelf, it has been there. You should have read it before now.

What does it say then? Look at Luke 13:6:

He spake also this parable; A certain man had a fig tree planted in his vineyard; and he came and sought fruit thereon, and found none. Then said he unto the dresser of his vineyard, Behold, these three years I come seeking fruit on this fig tree, and find none: cut it down; why cumbereth it the ground?

Stop right there.

Let us analyze this for a moment. He spake this parable. There was a certain man who had a fig tree, and this fig tree was planted in the midst of a vineyard. This fig tree was not only resisting the efforts of the ground it was planted in; it was also resisting the efforts of the vinedresser.

All of a sudden the destroyer came, wanting to destroy the tree. He said, "Look, this thing is fruitless. It has resisted the effort of the vinedresser. It has resisted the effort of the ground. Why let it live? Why let it cumber the ground? Why can it not be destroyed?"

You want to know why one man perishes and one does not? The reason that fig tree is not destroyed is because the vinedresser stepped in between the destroyer and the destruction of the fig tree.

Look at verse 8:

And he answering said unto him, Lord, let it alone...

Get this. He said, "Lord, let it alone."

Why does one man perish and one does not? It is not because one man is a greater sinner than another.

Why does that local hellion survive three airplane crashes, a train derailment, and sixteen car wrecks? He crawls out of a compartment this big, folds himself out, and says, "I did not get hurt again."

Science looks at him and says, "Well, he was filthy drunk, and when you are drunk, you are limber."

You are not that limber.

"Why was he not killed? He deserved to be."

I can tell you exactly why he was not killed. He probably had a gray-haired grandma who took the altar by the horns and is hanging on, standing between him and destruction as an intercessor, saying, "No, leave him alone."

That is why one man perishes and one man does not.

Listen to me. Why do you think the devil has fought so hard to remove tongues and intercession out of the Church? Why do you think he has made it a public scandal and ridiculed it? Why do you think he wants you to avoid, at any cost, all Spirit-based prayer?

Because the Holy Spirit knows the whole situation. He knows danger. When you grab the altar by the horns and start making intercession, the Holy Spirit raises you as a standard and places you between destruction and that person the devil has slated to destroy.

As an intercessor, you have rights to stand in the gap for your family. Not only your family, but your city.

The church I was born again in was a real holiness church. They put up such a standard that I could not make it. I just could not live up to their standard when I was first born again.

I can remember going to church, getting under conviction, throwing my smoking pipe out the window on the way home, and after a day or so buying another one. I threw them out the window. It cost me a lot of money for pipes.

There was a woman in there we called "the old woman." She was an old retired schoolteacher. She had raised her family, outlived her husband, and was the prayer warrior of the church.

Brother, some of those saints knew how to pray. All night long at the altar for the lost. All night.

Jeanne Wilkerson is a friend of mine, an intercessor. All through Vietnam, they did not lose one single young man in their church. Every night during the war, the ladies met down there under Jeanne Wilkerson and interceded, and they lost not one young man from that church to that war. Not one.

This woman's name was Sister Prior. They called her "the old woman." When it came time to pray, she would take her phone off the hook.

I will tell you what God did. He knew. I did not know I was called then, but God knew it, and God put that old woman on me. That woman would not give me a minute's peace. She took me on as some kind of prayer project.

I tried. I gave up. I could not live the standard, so I tried to give up and stay home. I missed one Sunday. One Sunday. The old woman was on my porch Monday after work, beating on my door so loudly it got absolutely embarrassing. The neighbors were coming out.

I would pull the curtains, turn the lights out, and act like I was not there.

She would yell, "I know you are in there."

She would keep beating on the door. The moment I opened the door, she would spring through the framework like a little banty hen. She would have her hands all over my head, casting devils out of me, and she would hold me down until I said I was delivered.

I could not miss church.

She died before I entered the ministry, but I asked Jesus to tell her about it, and I am sure He did. Are you not? Of course He told her.

The old woman would not let me backslide. But it was not just me. She told God, "There is one of my boys in the world yet. He is not saved. My other boys are. I am telling You right now, I am going to hold on to the horns of the altar, and I am not coming home until I know he is in the kingdom."

The old woman started suffering massive heart attacks, one after another. She ended up in the hospital. Her pastor was there. They had her hooked up to one of those heart monitors, and her vital signs were gone. The doctor kept looking at a quivering line for a heartbeat. It was just shaking and quivering, no beat.

They would scratch their heads, take her pulse, which they could not find, and then get other doctors. They would come in, scratch their heads, and examine her. They said, "It is a medical impossibility for this body to sustain life, but she keeps mumbling something. This woman will not die."

She kept mumbling.

They said her body could not sustain life, but it was. So the pastor came over, leaned down with his ear, and found out she was not mumbling. She was speaking out of her spirit. She was talking in tongues. They thought it was mumbling.

Brother Phillips got the interpretation, and all her boys had flown in for the funeral. The unsaved one was sitting over in the corner. Brother Phillips leaned over, got the interpretation, turned around, and said, "God told me she is not going to go home until all her boys are in the kingdom. Which one of you is not saved? You had better get over there, and you had better get born again. And you had better mean it, because if you do not mean it, the old woman will know."

He leaned over and said, "Mama, I am giving my heart to Jesus, and I will serve Him all my life. I mean it."

The old woman got a big old smile, and one worn-out angel escorted her home.

What is the potential of an intercessor? What is his potential? I would need a solid week to bring you gently into your potential without overloading you.

What is the potential of an intercessor? Have you ever begun to realize it? What is your potential? When you go after your city, what is the potential of an intercessory church? What chance does the strong man have?

It has never really been explored. But when I see Jesus making statements like this, the reason one man perishes and one does not is because the one who does not perish has an intercessor standing in the gap saying, "Let him alone. Let him alone for his lifetime. If he dies as a sinner, then you can have him. But let him alone for his allotted years."

Without intercessors, there is no one standing there.

I was preaching a Full Gospel regional with Ruth Heflin. She pastored at Jerusalem. When I found out Ruth Heflin had just come from Dr. Yonggi Cho's and had just had a meeting there, I immediately wanted to have dinner with her because I wanted to question somebody who had preached in the biggest church in the world. I wanted to find out Yonggi Cho's success.

Who can have a church that runs half a million people, four thousand full-time ministers, and four thousand intercessors on Prayer Mountain praying around the clock? Any time they find a problem person who needs deliverance or healing, they send them up on Prayer Mountain. When they get them back, they are healed. It is tremendous.

I said, "Ruth, what is the reason for Dr. Cho's tremendous success? I would really like to know."

When I first saw Dr. Yonggi Cho, I thought for sure he would have to be a cross between Clint Eastwood and John Wayne. I thought at least he would have to be, "This town is not big enough for both of us, so if you do not leave, devil, you are going to make my day."

Then when you saw Dr. Cho come out, there was one thing you realized for sure: this thing was not of the flesh.

"Got to believe God. Got to believe God. I believe God. I had a vision. The image of the Word. Meditate the Word and pray. Got to believe God. I believe God for a bicycle. First He gave me a bicycle."

And you thought, "My God, this is the pastor of the biggest church in the world."

Certainly not the flesh. In a way, I am glad. We would not want any unfair advantage.

I asked, "Why, Ruth Heflin?"

She did not want to talk about Dr. Cho so much. She wanted to talk about Sister Chae. That is Dr. Cho's mother-in-law. Believe me, this is one mother-in-law you would like to have.

I said, "What did she do?"

Sister Chae would enter into her prayer closet at dusk and emerge at dawn. She would pray in tongues, intercession, and groanings all night long. She would get edified in tongues, slip into the groanings, back into tongues, and back into the groanings as she was standing in the gap.

She did not do that one year, not two years, not three years, not four, not five, not six, not seven. By seven years, some of you would say, "I am going to be an intercessor," and make it two weeks.

Do you not think that after seven years, seeing nothing, she had to say in the truest form of faith, "I am not moved by what I see, hear, or feel. I am only moved by what I believe. My spirit declares the strong man over Seoul, Korea, is bound"?

She had to take herself by the ear and pull herself into the closet.

Seven years. Eight years. Nine years. Ten years.

Then Dr. Cho jumps up and says, "I have faith for a big church."

Where did he get it? God delivered him the bread she prayed down so he could deliver it to Seoul, Korea. The strong man's influence was broken off the religious mind, and all Dr. Cho had to do was get up and start preaching. He would preach about his bicycle and two thousand people could not get in. The next day he would get up and say, "Isn't it a wonderful day God has given us?" and six thousand people were waiting outside and could not even get in the building.

The power of the religious mind was broken.

He says if you are blinded, you are blinded by the god of this world. Let the glorious gospel shine through, and you see Jesus Christ through no veil for who He says He is.

That is what happened.

Just one of you has that potential. Just one of you. Not all of you. One of you. You just find out who you are.

I am going to stop with this because He is switching it on me.

There was a submarine in World War II, on the other side of the world, that lost power. They did not know why it lost power, but it sank to the bottom with only the batteries driving the life support system. Thirty-three men were aboard.

After numerous efforts, the batteries were running low, and they knew they were going to die. The captain got on the intercom and said, "Boys, unless there is some kind of miracle, we are in our watery grave. There is not a thing we can do about it."

As a final gesture, he said, "Is there anyone here who knows how to pray?"

Out of the thirty-three men, there was not one single man aboard who knew how to pray. Not one.

Finally, this young man came forward and said, "Look, I was raised under the pew. My mom dragged me to church. She is one of those tongue-talkers. But she dragged me to church until I got old enough to rebel and leave."

Talk about having trouble having a good time. How would you like to come in drunk and hear your gray-haired mama in the front room chair just pouring her heart out in intercession and travail for you? You have to slip past that mess to get to your bedroom.

That boy knew his mama knew how to pray.

He told the captain, "I do not know how to pray. We are all sinners. God will not hear us. But if we ask God, God will get hold of my mama, and boy, she can pray."

On the other side of the world, little gray-haired mama intercessor rolled out of bed. She had a vision immediately. She saw the whole situation, and brother, she went into travail. That woman knew how to pray.

I tell you what, if it were legal, I would feel sorry for the devil for touching that mama's boy. But it is not legal. Give him everything you can give him. Give him a lot of lumps.

She went into intercession. She went into travail. All of a sudden, for no apparent reason, the submarine dislodged, floated to the top under no power, and immediately thirty-three men came scrambling out.

They found the problem and made the repair. As soon as they were able, they made radio contact. What they made radio contact for was that these thirty-three men wanted to get hold of so-and-so's mother, because they wanted to find out how to be born again.

Hallelujah.

Jesus said a house divided against itself cannot stand. A city divided against itself cannot stand. A nation divided against itself cannot stand. But He said that in response to the accusation that Satan was casting out devils.

He said a stronger than he has to come upon him. That is the Spirit of God.

The house deliverance is a person getting delivered from a demon. A city deliverance is your city. A national deliverance is America. If a single house can be delivered, what He is saying is, so can the city.

God, what a miracle.

What is your potential as an intercessor? What do you think the devil gives you a thousand and one things to do about the time intercession starts rolling through?

God needs your authority. You are the body of Christ. Where His body is, that is where authority is. Where there are no believers, the town goes to hell unrestrained, not because God sends it, but because there are no believers.

But when believers are here, they become the avenue by which God releases His authority. When you give yourself unrestrainedly to God, He can pour that authority from the third heaven through your spirit. That is the authority that takes dominion over powers and principalities, drives them back, and causes you to take your cities.

He cannot do it without you.

People say God had a sovereign move. No, He did not. If you all moved out, the city would go to hell. He did not sovereignly choose one man over another. You are the one to whom He has delivered this eternity. You are the one He gave this awesome responsibility.

Does God sovereignly heal some and not others? No, He does not. If God sovereignly chose to heal me for some reason over you, that would make Him a respecter of persons, and you might as well disannul the rest of the Word of God.

He did not sovereignly choose to heal one.

"Well, it appears so. They were just standing there and they got healed."

Do you know their history? Do you know how many intercessors are in the bloodline who stood in the gap for them ten years ago before they ever walked in here, that nobody has record of but God?

You are going to have revival, you have to sow the field. You do not have revival unless you sow the field. Revival is on purpose. It is not a hopeful, wishful-thinking process.

God needs you. He needs you.

Do you not just love Him? Then you might as well give Him a hand.

He is worthy.